VTEST BUSINESS ENGLISH · LESSON 2

Listening. Understand Once. Answer Precisely.

COACH MODE EXAM-FEEL MODE

LESSON 1
Orientation ✓

LESSON 2
Listening

LESSON 3
Reading

LATER
Writing · Speaking

01 · LISTENING BRIEFING · 8 MIN

The audio only plays once. Your strategy starts before it plays.

Today you learn exactly what to do during the VTest Business English Listening module: preview, predict, listen for meaning, ignore traps, choose, and move on.

Remember: you do not need to understand every word. You need enough evidence to answer the question.

SEE THE LISTENING MAP AIDE EN FRANÇAIS

MODULE 01 · LISTENING

Candidate dashboard

Format	**Adaptive**
Recordings	**8–12**
Questions	**12–26**
Playback	**Once**
Today	**Guided → Exam**

NEXT

OFFICIAL LISTENING MAP

CURRENT BUSINESS ENGLISH FORMAT

Know the rules before you train the skill.

RECORDINGS	QUESTIONS	BEFORE AUDIO	AFTER AUDIO
8–12	12–26	30 sec	30 sec
One-speaker talks and two-speaker conversations.	The number and difficulty depend on your performance.	Preview the questions and predict what information matters.	Finish answering before the test auto-advances.

Training note: this page reproduces the published structure and exam behaviours for preparation. It is independent training material, not the official Burlington VTest platform.

02 · THE 30-SECOND PREVIEW · 8 MIN

Read first. Listen second.

PREVIEW
00:30

THE 5-STEP PREVIEW

1. **Read the question first.** What exactly must you find?
2. **Underline the difference.** Time? reason? person? action?
3. **Predict vocabulary.** Think of synonyms before the audio starts.
4. **Expect a correction.** The first number or idea may not be the final answer.

LISTENING · PREVIEW PRACTICE — QUESTION 1

What time will the client presentation begin?

- A · 9:00
- B · 9:30
- C · 10:00

5. **Do not translate.** Stay focused on evidence.

START 30-SECOND PREVIEW

Before listening: the difference between the answers is only the time . Listen especially for a correction such as *instead, actually, moved to, not... but...*

30 Can you identify the one detail you must catch before the timer reaches zero?

03 · GIST & PURPOSE · 10 MIN

GUIDED SET 1

Catch the situation before the details.

First listen for **who, where, why**. Do not chase every unknown word.

Main idea · One speaker A2–B1

WORKPLACE RECORDING

Listen for the answer — not every word.

Finished

▶ PLAY AUDIO ↻ REPLAY

1. Why is the speaker addressing the team?

A · To cancel today’s meeting

B · To announce a change to a demonstration

C · To introduce a new supplier

HINT 2-LEVEL MODEL

Correct ✓ The speaker's main purpose is to announce that the product demonstration has been moved.

2. What caused the change?

A · A supplier delivery issue

B · A problem with the sales team

C · A room reservation problem

HINT 2-LEVEL MODEL

A2–B1 B2–C1

The change is prompted by the supplier's inability to provide the samples before Wednesday.

Not quite. The supplier cannot deliver the new samples until Wednesday.

TRANSCRIPT

Good morning everyone. Before we start today's sales meeting, I need to let you know that the product demonstration has been moved to Thursday afternoon because the supplier cannot deliver the new samples until Wednesday. The rest of today's meeting will continue as planned.

04 · DETAILS & CHANGES · 12 MIN

GUIDED SET 2

The first detail is often a trap.

1

Correction trap

A speaker gives one detail, then changes it.

"At two — sorry, make that two-thirty."

2

Distractor trap

You hear a word from an option, but it does not answer the question.

The meeting is in Paris, but the question asks where the client is based.

3

Synonym trap

The answer uses different words from the recording.

"postpone" → "move to a later date"

Correction · Time and action A2–B1

WORKPLACE RECORDING

Listen for the answer — not every word.

Finished

▶ PLAY AUDIO ↻ REPLAY

1. What time will the client call start?

A · 9:00

B · 9:15

C · 9:30

HINT 2-LEVEL MODEL

Correct ✓ 9:00 was the original plan; the final start time is 9:30.

2. What must Marta do before 9:15?

A · Call the client

B · Send the revised figures

C · Check the figures herself

HINT 2-LEVEL MODEL

Correct ✓ Marta must send the revised figures; the speaker will check them.

TRANSCRIPT

05 · INTENTION & INFERENCE · 10 MIN

GUIDED SET 3

Listen for what the speaker means, not only what they say.

At higher levels, the answer may depend on tone, implication, purpose, or what is most likely to happen next.

Purpose · Indirect meaning B1–B2

WORKPLACE RECORDING

Listen for the answer — not every word.

Finished

▶ PLAY AUDIO ↻ REPLAY

1. What does the speaker want the listener to do?

A · Rewrite the whole proposal

B · Clarify one part of the proposal

C · Send the proposal immediately

HINT 2-LEVEL MODEL

Correct ✓ The overall proposal is strong; only the cost section and staffing expense need clearer explanation.

2. How does the speaker feel about the proposal overall?

A · Mostly positive but not ready to approve it yet

B · Completely dissatisfied

C · Uninterested in the proposal

HINT 2-LEVEL MODEL

A2–B1 B2–C1

The speaker likes the proposal but wants one change first.

Correct ✓ The language is positive overall, with one condition before approval.

TRANSCRIPT

I appreciate the work you have put into the proposal. The overall direction is strong, but I think the cost section needs another look before we send it to the board. If we can explain the additional staffing expense more clearly, I will be comfortable putting it forward on Friday.

06 · TWO-SPEAKER CONVERSATIONS · 10 MIN

GUIDED SET 4

Track the speakers separately.

1 · IDENTIFY	2 · SEPARATE	3 · COMPARE	4 · NOTICE	5 · ANSWER
Who is speaking?	What does A want?	What does B say?	Agreement or change?	Use the final outcome.

Two speakers · Final decision B1–B2

WORKPLACE RECORDING

Listen for the answer — not every word.

Finished

▶ PLAY AUDIO ↻ REPLAY

1. Why can't they use the conference room?

A · The projector is broken

B · It has already been booked

C · It is too small

HINT 2-LEVEL MODEL

Not quite. Finance has booked the conference room all day.

2. What will the man probably do next?

A · Cancel the workshop

B · Reserve the smaller room and update participants

C · Ask Finance to move its meeting

HINT 2-LEVEL MODEL

Correct ✓ He says he will reserve the smaller room and send the updated schedule.

TRANSCRIPT

Woman: We could move the training workshop to the conference room on the third floor. It is bigger and the projector is already installed. Man: I checked it this morning, but Finance has booked it all day. What about the smaller room next to reception? Woman: That could work if we divide the participants into two groups. Man: Good idea. I'll reserve it now and send everyone the updated schedule.

07 · ADAPTIVE CHALLENGE · 10 MIN

A2 → B1 → B2/C1

If it gets harder, keep the same method.

YOUR JOB DOES NOT CHANGE

Difficulty changes. Method stays stable.

As the language becomes faster or more indirect, return to the question. Identify the evidence you need and ignore information that does not help answer it.

A2 B1 B2 C1

Inference · Recommendation B2–C1

WORKPLACE RECORDING

Listen for the answer — not every word.

Finished

▶ PLAY AUDIO ↻ REPLAY

1. What does the speaker recommend?

A · Ending the discount programme now

B · Expanding it nationally immediately

C · Continuing it in current markets before deciding

HINT 2-LEVEL MODEL

Correct ✓ The speaker wants one more quarter in current markets before reassessing national expansion.

2. Why is the speaker cautious?

A · All regions are performing badly

B · The positive results may not yet be reliable enough

C · The programme is too expensive to continue

HINT 2-LEVEL MODEL

Correct ✓ Improvement is limited to two regions, so the speaker wants evidence that the gains will last.

TRANSCRIPT

We have reviewed the first quarter figures, and the decline in renewals is smaller than we feared. That said, the improvement is concentrated in two regions, while the corporate segment continues to underperform. I would hesitate to expand the discount programme nationally until we know whether those regional gains are sustainable. My preference would be to run it for another quarter in the current markets, then reassess.

08 · COMPLETE EXAM-FEEL SIMULATION · 20–25 MIN

SIMULATOR
REVIEW

Now remove the training wheels.

This simulator uses **8 recordings and 14 questions**, matching the lower end of the official module range. In Exam-feel Mode, audio is available once, support disappears, and feedback waits until the end.

Before you start: switch to **EXAM-FEEL MODE**. You can return to Coach Mode afterward to review mistakes.

Listening simulation complete DONE

SIMULATION RESULT

13 / 14 correct

This is a training score, not a VTest CEFR result. Review the question families below, then repeat in Exam-feel Mode on another day.

CORRECT	TOTAL	ACCURACY	RECORDINGS
13	14	93%	8

Recording 1 · Q1 · detail
✓ Correct — answer: B · Room 204

Recording 1 · Q2 · detail
✓ Correct — answer: B · 10:00

Recording 2 · Q1 · purpose
✓ Correct — answer: B · To request a corrected invoice

Recording 2 · Q2 · detail

✓ Correct — answer: A · The purchase order number

Recording 3 · Q1 · gist
✓ Correct — answer: B · Wednesday remote work

Recording 3 · Q2 · detail
✓ Correct — answer: B · Two people remain in the office

Recording 4 · Q1 · purpose
✓ Correct — answer: B · Earlier delivery of the final files

Recording 4 · Q2 · sequence
✓ Correct — answer: A · The client must send written approval

Recording 5 · Q1 · next action
✓ Correct — answer: B · Interview recent users

Recording 5 · Q2 · inference
✓ Correct — answer: A · To understand customer priorities

Recording 6 · Q1 · purpose
✓ Correct — answer: C · Delegation

Recording 6 · Q2 · cause/effect
✓ Correct — answer: A · Less time for strategic planning

Recording 7 · Q1 · decision
✗ Review — answer: B · Use part of a future budget earlier

Recording 8 · Q1 · inference
✓ Correct — answer: B · The overall result may hide differences between groups

BACK · COACH ONLY

SUBMIT LISTENING

OPTIONAL ORAL TRANSFER · TRAINING ONLY

NOT PART OF LISTENING SCORE

Explain what you heard.

SPEAK FOR 30–45 SEC

Summarise one workplace recording.

Say: 1) the situation, 2) the problem or purpose, 3) the final action or decision.

Key words only: situation → problem → action

• RECORD STOP 00:45

A2–B1 MODEL B2–C1 MODEL

> The speakers are discussing a delivery problem. The order will arrive late because of a transport delay. They decide to inform the client and send a new delivery time.

09 · LISTENING LANGUAGE BANK · 8 MIN

EN · FR · EXAMPLE · AUDIO

Words that tell you where the answer is hiding.

CHANGES PURPOSE CONTRAST SIGNALS

↺ reschedule ▶ AUDIO

reprogrammer

We need to reschedule the review for Friday.

→ postpone ▶ AUDIO

reporter

The launch has been postponed until next month.

≠ instead ▶ AUDIO

✓ final ▶ AUDIO

à la place

We will meet online instead.

définitif

The final deadline is Tuesday.

10 · LISTENING REPORT

SAVE YOUR RESULT

Know what to repeat before Lesson 3.

YOUR LISTENING CHECKPOINT

Strong control of this listening set.

Move forward, but repeat the hardest B2/C1 items without support to protect your consistency.

DOWNLOAD RESULTS PRINT / PDF

SIM SCORE

13/14

93% TRAINING ACCURACY

DECISION · 0/1 correct

DETAIL · 4/4 correct

PURPOSE · 3/3 correct

GIST · 1/1 correct

SEQUENCE · 1/1 correct

NEXT ACTION · 1/1 correct

INFERENCE · 2/2 correct

CAUSE/EFFECT · 1/1 correct

VTEST SERIES PROGRESS

Your Final Center

Saved in this browser

LESSON 1 · Course map

Orientation

Complete ✓

Orientation and exam map explored.

LESSON 2 · Module 1

Listening

93%

13/14 correct · submitted

LESSON 3 · Next

Reading

—

Not completed yet.

LESSON 4 · Later

Writing

—

Not completed yet.

AVERAGE OF SUBMITTED SCORED MODULES **93%**

NEXT IN THE SERIES

Lesson 3 · Reading — Find the Proof.

The same VTest Practice Lab interface will continue into the Reading module: 9 texts, adaptive progression, up to five minutes per text, guided skimming/scanning first, then a full Exam-feel simulation.

Format reference: Burlington VTest Business English public candidate information and sample-module guidance, checked September 2026.

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VTEST PRACTICE LAB

A+ Contrast Reset